

Roost

Target Market — Student Accommodation Booking Platform

Roost is designed around the needs of South African students navigating a scarce, scam-prone off-campus housing market. The target market splits into a primary user group (students) and a secondary group (landlords and agencies), with distinct behavioural traits shaping product priorities.

Primary Target Group: Students

- NSFAS-funded university and TVET college students searching for off-campus accommodation
- First-year students unfamiliar with the local rental market, and most vulnerable to scams
- Students at institutions with limited on-campus residence capacity, a common issue at large South African universities

Secondary Target Group: Landlords & Agencies

- Verified private landlords and property owners near campuses seeking NSFAS-accredited status to attract reliable, funded tenants
- Student accommodation agencies looking for a trustworthy listing channel

Demographic & Psychographic Traits

- Budget-constrained and price-sensitive, tied to fixed NSFAS allowance amounts
- Mobile-first users, likely to browse and book primarily via smartphone
- Time-pressured, often searching close to registration deadlines
- Wary of scams due to prior bad experiences or word-of-mouth warnings
- Limited access to a personal network or family support in the city they are relocating to

Prepared as supporting material for the Roost coursework project — student accommodation booking platform for South African students.